

Affirmative Team Speaker Duties

Each member has slightly different responsibilities and must effectively accomplish them for the team to win the debate. As we talk about each member's responsibilities, we will look at examples based on this topic:

Resolved: the USFG should significantly increase the use of alternate energy sources.

First Affirmation Constructive Speech

Start with an Introduction that introduces your topic and states the resolution –

- **Example:** *Oil is becoming more and more expensive. Because of this and other reasons we will soon discuss, we of the affirmation believe that we should adopt the resolution that states: The USFG should significantly increase the use of alternate energy sources.*

Next provide your “roadmap” or an outline of what you will cover in the next few minutes.

- **Example:** *In the next few minutes, I will first frame the debate, define the terms of the resolution and then I will provide several reasons why using alternate energy sources are a better solution for America.*

Third on the list is to frame your debate and define your terms – tell what kind of a resolution it is (fact, value, or policy), what judging criteria should be applied to this debate (nets benefit, greatest impact, preponderance of evidence, or cost benefit), and give the definition of key terms.

- **Example:** *This is a policy debate, and it will be our job to show you that the US needs to change the status quo. We believe this debate should be judged on a preponderance of evidence, and we will present overwhelming evidence to show this resolution needs adoption. We would now like to define the one key terms in the resolution we're debating as follows: alternate energy sources will be all energy sources other than oil and nuclear power.*

Note – when defining terms, you can use a dictionary, encyclopedia, or common knowledge to define the words. Being fair with the way you define them is important. Remember that your definitions should fulfill the INTENT of the motion – in other words, they should capture what the author really intended you to debate. And frankly, you don't want your definitions to be so strange or “off” that the whole debate deteriorates to a debate about your definitions. These types of definitions open you to Topicality arguments.

Present your Affirmation case. Give each argument and the evidence that supports it. Most cases will have a minimum of three arguments or reasons for supporting the resolution.

- **Example:** *Our first argument is that we are too dependent on oil from other countries. (After you stated your argument, you would give any information that you had that supported that argument. I will discuss later how to structure your arguments effectively.)*

If you are debating a policy resolution you will need to follow the Harm, Inherency, Plan, Solvency, Advantages organizational pattern.

End with the conclusion: You quickly summarize your key points and urge a vote for the Affirmation.

First Affirmative Checklist

- ☐ I have given a short Introduction
- ☐ I have stated the resolution.
- ☐ I have provided a road map
- ☐ I have framed the debate
 - ☐ I told what kind of resolution it was
 - ☐ I gave a judging criterion
 - ☐ I defined the terms.
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have provided a plan
- ☐ I have presented 2 – 3 contentions.
- ☐ I have given a conclusion

Second Affirmation Constructive Speech

Start with a strong opening line and reaffirm that you believe in the proposition.

- **Example:** *How we handle energy in the next few years will be vitally important. My partner and I continue to believe that alternate energy sources are our best future, and we support the resolution: Resolved: the USFG should significantly increase the use of alternate energy sources.*

Next give a roadmap of your speech – tell the judge what order you will be discussing things.

- **Example:** *During these 8 minutes, I will first discuss the negation's concerns with the definitions, then I will address the Negation's case, and finally I will go back to the affirmation's contentions and show why the responses of the Negation aren't significant. Let's begin....*

If they attacked any elements of your framing of the debate – the type of resolution it was, the judging criteria, or the definition of terms, you must explain why the Negative is wrong and you are right.

Go to the negation's case arguments – state each one and then refute it – in other words, break it down.

- **Example:** *The negation told you that developing alternate energy sources will cost too much. We disagree. We believe that we will stimulate the economy by creating jobs. Researching and developing alternate energy sources will provide hundreds of thousands of new jobs in our economy. Giving handouts in terms of longer unemployment benefits or more food stamps is only a short-term solution. Creating new jobs for those on unemployment will create lasting and sustainable economic growth.*

If you are doing a policy debate, and the Negative attacked your plan, you must answer their attacks. Don't forget to use **FIAT** if it applies.

Next, go back to your affirmation contentions and **REBUILD** them. Don't simply repeat them, but analyze what the negation said and show that it is not correct. You want to **EXTEND** on their analysis.

- **Example:** *Our first argument was that dependence on oil was bad. The Negation wants us to first show you the harm in this. I would point to the recent hike in gas prices. The U.S. is at the*

mercy of oil rich countries, and they can charge whatever they want for their oil. The higher cost must be born by U.S. drivers, and that's a real hardship for many. That is the harm. Next, they tell you we could use oil supplies we have here in the U.S. – we would argue that getting that oil would require drilling in highly environmentally sensitive areas. Look at the recent oil spill in the gulf region of the U.S. It is better all around to lessen our dependence on oil and look at friendlier alternative energy sources that will free us from oil-wealthy countries.

Finally, summarize the Affirmative position for the judge.

- **Example:** *Let's look back. The Affirmative has given you three significant and unique arguments showing that using alternate energy sources must be our top priority. We have analyzed the negative's contentions, proving that developing jobs from alternative energy sources is the BEST way to help the economy, and that, contrary to their assertion, alternate forms of energy are well-developed enough to be a viable energy source. The conclusion is simple: a vote for the Affirmation.*

Second Affirmative Checklist

- ☐ I have given a short Introduction
- ☐ I have re-affirmed our position in favor of the resolution.
- ☐ I have provided a road map
- ☐ If the Negative didn't like how we framed the debate, I have answered their concerns:
- ☐ If they didn't like how we labeled the type of motion I have explained why we are correct.
- ☐ If they suggested another judging criteria, I have explained why ours is better.
- ☐ If they didn't like our Definition of Terms, I have explained why ours are fair
- ☐ I have attacked each of the negative contentions
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have answered any attacks on our Affirmative plan
- ☐ I have used fiat (if it applies) and explained to the judge what fiat is
- ☐ I have rebuilt each of our claims or contentions
 - ☐ I have pointed out the flaws in the Negative attacks
 - ☐ I have extended arguments – not just repeated what my partner said
- ☐ I have given a conclusion.